

7 On Nov. 26, the Sutlej Jal Vidyut Nigam Limited workers begin vertical drilling (1m dia.) from above the tunnel at about 300m from the Silkyara side. By Nov. 28, 45m, or half of the desired depth, had been drilled

6 The Rail Vikas Nigam Limited also initiates vertical drilling (8 inches dia.). By Nov. 28, 72m completed. Meanwhile, THDC India Ltd begins horizontal drilling using blast method from the Barkot side

THE RESCUE TEAM

- PMO: Former advisor Bhaskar Khulbe remained at the site; principal secretary P.K. Mishra also took stock
- Being the apex body, National Disaster Management Authority oversaw rescue operation at all fronts
- National Disaster Response Force provided ground support along with the Uttarakhand SDRF
- National Highways & Infrastructure Development Corporation Ltd oversaw the drilling of the main rescue tunnel
- Geological Survey of India assessed the stability of the surrounding terrain
- Border Roads Organisation built approach roads for heavy machinery
- Army, Air Force, Railways, ONGC and Uttarakhand govt gave logistical support
- Arnold Dix, an Australian expert on tunnel rescues, was present at the site

5 With just about 12m of drilling left, the auger machine is halted on Nov. 22 as a metallic hurdle (lattice girder bars) is encountered, making it impossible to insert the pipe further. Gas cutters are deployed to remove the hurdle, and work is completed on Nov. 23 night. But boring through the rubble has to be put on hold, as experts start exploring other options, including vertical and manual drilling

600
APPROX. NO. OF PEOPLE ENGAGED IN RESCUE WORK AT THE SITE

60
METRE
WIDTH OF THE RUBBLE THAT HAD TO BE DRILLED THROUGH